UPSC CIVIL SERVICES · DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

FRIDAY, 16 OCTOBER 2026

21 must-know stories, 19 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 911 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

The Census (Amendment) Rules, 2026

The Ministry of Home Affairs has introduced the Census (Amendment) Rules, 2026, under the Census Act, 1948. The Ministry issued a Gazette notification to formally enact these revised rules. The amendment expands the pool of eligible enumerators who can conduct the census data collection. State governments and UT administrations can now appoint teachers from both government and private institutions as enumerators. Eligible teachers include those from government, local authority, aided, and unaided private educational institutions, alongside trust or society-run schools. Clerks and other officials from Central and State Governments, local authorities, and diverse establishments are now included. Eligible establishments also cover public sector undertakings, statutory bodies, banks, companies, institutions, societies, and trusts.

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Home Affairs · **Prelims:** The rules were introduced under the Census Act, 1948.; The amendment was issued by the Ministry of Home Affairs.; Eligible teachers now include those from aided and unaided private educational institutions.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands the manpower pool available to state governments and Union Territory administrations for conducting large-scale census operations.; Incorporates personnel from private educational institutions, banks, PSUs, and companies to ease the administrative burden of data collection.*

Static — The Census in India is conducted under the provisions of the Census Act, 1948, which provides the legal framework for carrying out decennial population censuses. The responsibility of conducting the decennial census rests with the Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, India, under the Ministry of Home Affairs. Census data is a vital database used for evidence-based policymaking, administrative planning, resource allocation, and delimitation of electoral constituencies across the country.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Act/Bill/Rules

Insights on India: read the source · free copy on newsonair.gov.in · also reported by Hindustan Times, Times of India, LatestLY, Babushahi.com

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Special Parliament Session Likely This Month To Pass Women's Quota, Delimitation Bills

The government is likely to convene a special session of Parliament later this month to take up constitutional amendment bills on delimitation and women's reservation. The move comes amid intensifying Opposition protests against the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Government sources claim the Centre has the numbers required to secure passage in the Lok Sabha following recent defections from the Opposition. A constitutional amendment requires a special majority of around 360 seats, which the NDA fell short of during a previous defeat on April 17. The government's position strengthened after 20 Trinamool Congress MPs and six Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs switched to the ruling side. The Centre is also in talks with the DMK and smaller Opposition parties to secure further support after the DMK exited the INDIA bloc. The Monsoon Session concluded on August 13 and has not yet been prorogued, leaving room for a special sitting. Dates for the session are expected to be finalized around the 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum scheduled at Samvidhan Sadan on October 26 and 27.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** Samvidhan Sadan, New Delhi · **Who:** Gyanesh Kumar, Government, Trinamool Congress MPs, Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs, DMK · **Prelims:** The current Lok Sabha has 540 members.; A two-thirds majority for passing constitutional amendments in the current Lok Sabha requires around 360 seats.; The 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum is scheduled to be held at Samvidhan Sadan on October 26 and 27.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the evolving dynamics of parliamentary numbers and floor management in pushing crucial constitutional amendments.; Demonstrates the strategic political realignments and regional party shifts occurring outside major opposition blocs.*

Static — A Constitutional Amendment Bill requires a special majority under Article 368, meaning a majority of the total membership and a two-thirds majority of members present and voting in each House of Parliament. Delimitation is the act of redrawing boundaries of Lok Sabha and

State Assembly constituencies to reflect changes in population, carried out by a Delimitation Commission. Article 82 of the Constitution mandates readjustment of constituency boundaries after every census, though Parliament previously froze it until the first census after 2026.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Place in news, Act/Bill/Rules

NDTV: read the source · free copy on indiatoday.in · also reported by ET Government, News18, Moneycontrol.com, India Today

GS2 MAKE NOTES

CEC and EC Immunity – Section 16 of the 2023 Act and Article 14

The Supreme Court issued notice to the Union government on a petition filed by the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) challenging Section 16 of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023. Section 16 bars courts from entertaining or continuing civil or criminal proceedings against serving or former CECs and ECs for acts done in the discharge of official duties. The core debate centers on balancing institutional independence for election officials with constitutional legal accountability and equality before the law. The Union Law Minister justified the amendment stating it would enable the CEC and ECs to perform their functions independently and without hindrance. The provision was not part of the original Bill but was added through an amendment on the day it was passed by the Rajya Sabha, before getting Lok Sabha approval and Presidential assent. Critics argue that lifelong absolute immunity creates unequal treatment compared to other independent constitutional bodies and lacks a clear legislative rationale in the Statement of Objects and Reasons. The previous governing law, the Election Commission Act of 1991, did not contain an equivalent immunity provision for election commissioners.

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court, Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR), Union Government · **Prelims:** The petition challenging Section 16 was filed by the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR).; Section 16 bars civil or criminal proceedings against serving or former CECs and ECs for official acts.; The 2023 Act governing CEC and EC service conditions replaced the earlier 1991 Act.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It tests the limits of legislative immunity granted to constitutional authorities outside the President and Governors.; It highlights the tension between protecting institutional independence and preserving judicial accountability for public officials.*

Static — Article 14 of the Constitution guarantees equality before the law and equal protection of the laws, permitting different treatment only through a reasonable classification based on an intelligible differentia with a rational nexus to a legislative objective. Article 361 provides personal immunity to the President and Governors from criminal proceedings and arrest during their terms of office, with a two-month prior notice required for civil proceedings regarding personal acts. Articles 105 and 194 provide legislative privileges, including freedom of speech and immunity from court proceedings for votes cast or opinions expressed in Parliament and State Legislatures respectively.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules, Judgment

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source · also reported by NewsDrum

GS2 MAKE NOTES

MP government moves Supreme Court against HC verdict striking down 27% OBC quota

The Madhya Pradesh government filed a Special Leave Petition in the Supreme Court challenging the High Court verdict that struck down the 27 per cent OBC quota. The trigger was the October 9, 2026 Madhya Pradesh High Court judgment declaring the 2019 law raising OBC reservation from 14 to 27 per cent unconstitutional. The core legal debate centers on whether the state can cross the 50 per cent total reservation ceiling without exceptional circumstances laid down in judicial precedents. The challenged 2019 law was introduced as an ordinance by the Kamal Nath-led Congress government in March 2019 and enacted in August 2019. Chief Minister Dr Mohan Yadav stated that the state government is committed to protecting OBC interests and had ordered a detailed examination of the High Court judgment. The Office of the Advocate General, Madhya Pradesh, filed the SLP in the case titled State of Madhya Pradesh vs. Ashita Dubey and Others. Political pressure intensified as the OBC Mahasabha warned of statewide agitations, while the Bhim Army and Azad Samaj Party demanded a special assembly session.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** Madhya Pradesh, Bhopal, Jabalpur · **Who:** Dr Mohan Yadav, OBC Mahasabha, Madhya Pradesh High Court, Supreme Court · **Prelims:** The 2019 law raised the OBC reservation quota in Madhya Pradesh from 14 per cent to 27 per cent.; The Madhya Pradesh High Court delivered its judgment striking down the quota on October 9, 2026.; The case in the Supreme Court is filed as State of Madhya Pradesh vs. Ashita Dubey and Others.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the ongoing friction between state legislative actions expanding affirmative action and judicial limits on reservations.; Has direct operational consequences for public employment and higher education admissions in Madhya Pradesh.*

Static — Article 15 and Article 16 of the Constitution of India empower the state to make special provisions for the advancement of socially and educationally backward classes. The Supreme Court in the landmark Indra Sawhney case (1992) capped total reservations at 50 per cent, barring extraordinary situations. Special Leave Petitions under Article 136 of the Constitution grant the Supreme Court extraordinary discretionary power to grant special leave to appeal against any judgment.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Judgment

newindianexpress.com: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Flags AI-Generated Fake Judgments In Compilation, Upholds Insolvency Admission

The Supreme Court criticised an advocate-on-record for attempting to shift blame onto litigants after submitting a compilation of judgments alleged to contain AI-generated non-existent decisions. The controversy erupted when respondents raised immediate objections stating that the compilation submitted by the appellants was replete with fabricated judgments. The advocate-on-record feigned ignorance of the contents, while senior counsel subsequently accepted responsibility and sought forgiveness on behalf of the appellants. The Court initially proposed imposing exemplary costs on the appellants for this conduct but ultimately refrained from doing so due to the death of the first appellant, Deepak Raheja. The judgment delivered on October 15 did not identify the allegedly fabricated decisions or record a separate finding of AI generation. The underlying appeals challenged insolvency proceedings against Gstaad Hotels Private Limited and Neo Capricorn Plaza Private Limited operating luxury hotels in Bengaluru and Pune. The insolvency proceedings were initiated by Omkara Assets Reconstruction Private Limited following loan defaults originally extended by Piramal Finance. The Supreme Court dismissed the appeals on merits and held that the NCLT is not required to determine precise outstanding liability before admitting an insolvency application.

When: October 15, 2026 · **Where:** Bengaluru and Pune · **Who:** Justices Dipankar Datta and Augustine George Masih, Omkara Assets Reconstruction Private Limited, Gstaad Hotels Private Limited, Neo Capricorn Plaza Private Limited · **Prelims:** The judgment was delivered on October 15.; Gstaad Hotels Private Limited operates the JW Marriott Hotel in Bengaluru.; Neo Capricorn Plaza Private Limited operates the Crowne Plaza Hotel in Pune.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the growing judicial concern regarding the unverified use of artificial intelligence and fake citations in legal filings.; Reinforces the statutory position that the NCLT does not need to determine exact outstanding liabilities before admitting an insolvency application under the IBC.*

Static — The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) was enacted in 2016 to consolidate and amend laws relating to reorganisation and insolvency resolution of corporate persons. The National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) acts as the adjudicating authority for corporate insolvency resolution under the IBC framework. Under Section 7 of the IBC, a financial creditor can initiate Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) against a corporate debtor upon default.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Economy, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Judgment

barandbench.com: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

ASDD bulk deletions effected by ECI without due procedure through autogenerated Form-7s signed by EROs

Reports surfaced that lakhs of voters were deleted using auto-generated Form-7s where the ERO replaced the objector and skipped the mandatory notice period. The Election Commission of India carried out bulk deletions of voters under Absent, Shifted, Dead, and Duplicate categories using auto-generated Form-7s signed directly by Electoral Registration Officers without following due notice procedures. Deletions were effected without notice period

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Election Commission of India, Electoral Registration Officers · **Prelims:** Form-7 is used for objecting to inclusion or seeking deletion of a name in the electoral roll.; EROs stand for Electoral Registration Officers.; ASDD stands for Absent, Shifted, Dead, and Duplicate voter categories.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights systemic vulnerabilities in electoral roll management and arbitrary administrative actions.; Raises critical questions on the protection of universal adult suffrage and the right to vote.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional body responsible for administering election processes in India under Article 324. Electoral Registration Officers are appointed under Section 13-B of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, to prepare and revise electoral rolls. Form-7 is the prescribed statutory form under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, used for raising objections to inclusion or seeking deletion of a name.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

The Hindu: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Rules That Religious Conversion Does Not Automatically Preserve Backward Class Reservation

The Supreme Court upheld a Madras High Court judgment striking down a Tamil Nadu government order allowing converts to Islam to obtain Backward Class Muslim community certificates. The Bench of Justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and Shree Chandrashekhar ruled that conversion to Islam does not automatically grant membership to any of the seven notified backward class Muslim communities. The state had argued the government order protected reservation benefits for socially disadvantaged individuals who exercised their fundamental right to practise a religion of their choice under Article 25. The dispute concerned Government Order (Ms) No. 31, issued on March 9, 2024, following a recommendation by the Tamil Nadu Backward Classes Commission. Tamil Nadu provides a separate 3.5 per cent sub-quota for Backward Class Muslims within its existing reservation framework. The Supreme Court held that the government order created an artificial route to reservation benefits without establishing necessary social and legal connections. The court clarified that a community certificate merely declares an existing status and cannot override constitutional or statutory eligibility requirements.

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** Tamil Nadu, New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court of Justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and Shree Chandrashekhar, Tamil Nadu Government, Paramasivam (Sameer Ahamed) · **Prelims:** Government Order (Ms) No. 31 was issued on March 9, 2024, in Tamil Nadu.; Tamil Nadu provides a 3.5 per cent sub-quota for Backward Class Muslims.; Paragraph 3 of the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order restricts SC status to Hinduism, Sikhism, and Buddhism.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Clarifies the legal limits of executive orders in altering statutory reservation criteria based on religious conversion.; Reaffirms constitutional and statutory restrictions regarding Scheduled Caste eligibility linked to specific religions.*

Static — Reservation in India is governed by Articles 15 and 16 of the Constitution, which empower the State to make special provisions for the advancement of socially and educationally backward classes. The Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950, originally restricted Scheduled Caste status only to Hindus, later amended to include Sikhs (1956) and Buddhists (1990), but excludes Muslims and Christians. State governments possess the power to identify and notify Backward Classes and Most Backward Classes within their jurisdictions, often creating sub-quotas such as the Backward Class Muslim sub-quota in Tamil Nadu.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

freepressjournal.in: read the source · also reported by Times of India, www.nationpathindia.com, The Economic Times

GS2 MAKE NOTES

‘Citizens can challenge false poll affidavits without ECI sanction’, says Supreme Court

The Supreme Court ruled that private citizens can file criminal complaints against elected candidates for false information or concealed facts in election affidavits. The bench stated that Section 195 of the Code of Criminal Procedure does not bar such private complaints for offences under the Representation of the People Act. The core issue debated was whether private individuals could initiate criminal proceedings or if such action required a formal complaint solely by an authorised public servant. Section 125A of the Representation of the People Act penalises candidates providing false information, concealing details, or failing to mandatory disclosures in nomination papers. The judgment disposed of an appeal filed by Rajkumar Madki against a Karnataka High Court order dated March 7, 2025. Madki had alleged that Shailendra Beldale, an MLA from Bidar, made a false declaration about his residential address in his 2023 Assembly election affidavit. The Karnataka High Court had previously quashed the complaint, ruling that proceedings could only be initiated via a complaint by the Election Commission or an election petition.

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** Karnataka · **Who:** Supreme Court bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu, Rajkumar Madki, Shailendra Beldale · **Prelims:** Section 125A of the Representation of the People Act penalises false information in election affidavits.; Section 195 of the CrPC bars courts from taking cognizance of certain offences without a public servant's complaint.; The case involved an appeal filed by Rajkumar Madki against Shailendra Beldale, an MLA from the Bidar constituency.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Empowers ordinary citizens and voters to directly hold election candidates accountable for perjury and false declarations.; Clarifies the legal scope of Section 125A of the Representation of the People Act vis-a-vis the Code of Criminal Procedure.*

Static — The Representation of the People Act, 1951, governs the conduct of elections of Houses of Parliament and the State Legislatures, outlining qualifications and disqualifications. Section 195 of the Code of Criminal Procedure bars courts from taking cognizance of certain offences unless a written complaint is made by a public servant. Election affidavits are mandatory declarations submitted by candidates detailing their criminal antecedents, assets, liabilities, and educational qualifications.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

Hindustan Times: read the source · free copy on indiatoday.in · also reported by Telegraph India

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

National Steering Committee Approves Rs. 1,194.92 Crore Investment Under PM-SETU for Five ITI Clusters Across Maharashtra, Odisha and Jammu & Kashmir

The National Steering Committee of PM-SETU approved investments worth Rs 1,194.92 crore for upgrading five ITI clusters across Maharashtra, Odisha, and Jammu and Kashmir. The approvals were granted during the sixth meeting of the National Steering Committee held under the chairpersonship of MSDE Secretary Debashree Mukherjee. The initiative aims to modernize infrastructure, introduce industry-aligned courses, strengthen trainer capacity, and enhance employment opportunities for youth. The Jammu ITI cluster received Rs 240 crore in partnership with Eagle Infra India Limited, with Government ITI Jammu as the hub. The Srinagar ITI cluster received Rs 235.41 crore in partnership with Inderdeep Infra India, with Government ITI Srinagar as the hub. In Odisha, the Cuttack ITI cluster secured Rs 240.50 crore in partnership with Tata Steel Foundation. In Maharashtra, the Pune cluster received Rs 241 crore with BVG India Limited, and Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar secured Rs 238.01 crore with Belrise Industries Limited. With these new approvals, the cumulative investment sanctioned under the PM-SETU scheme has reached Rs 3,687 crore. The committee also reviewed trainer training progress, noting that 3,744 trainers had been trained through National Skill Training Institutes by October 2026.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** Jammu and Kashmir, Maharashtra, Odisha · **Who:** Debashree Mukherjee, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship · **Prelims:** Total fresh investment approved: Rs 1,194.92 crore across 5 ITI clusters.; Cumulative investment under PM-SETU: Rs 3,687 crore.; Trainers trained under the scheme by October 2026: 3,744 trainers.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands high-end skill development infrastructure and modern training facilities in Jammu and Kashmir.; Fosters robust industry-academia collaboration through direct partnerships with corporate entities and foundations.*

Static — Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) in India function under the Directorate General of Training (DGT), Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, providing vocational training. Vocational education and training falls under the Concurrent List of the Indian Constitution, allowing both central and state governments to formulate policies. Skill development schemes in India aim to bridge the gap between industry demand and workforce supply through standardized curricula and certification.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

PIB: read the source · *free copy on greaterkashmir.com*

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Inside the 18th BRICS Summit: Trade wars, de-dollarization and India’s strategic autonomy

The summit convened to deliberate on global trade, currency alternatives, and strategic autonomy. The 18th BRICS Summit addressed global trade tensions, de-dollarization trends, and member-state relations.

When: 2026-10-16 · **Who:** BRICS member states

> ***Why it matters —*** *Relevance to India's foreign policy and multi-alignment strategy.; Exam focus on reforms in global economic and financial architecture.*

Static — BRICS was originally formed as BRIC following a meeting of foreign ministers in New York in 2006. The first formal summit took place in Yekaterinburg, Russia, in 2009. South Africa joined the grouping in 2010, expanding the bloc into BRICS.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

ET Government: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

PM Modi’s Seychelles visit yields major agreements on UPI, healthcare, space and development cooperation

Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited Seychelles on a State Visit at the invitation of President Dr. Patrick Herminie. The visit coincided with the Golden Jubilee celebrations of Seychelles’ Independence, where PM Modi attended as the Guest of Honour. The core issue focuses on deepening strategic, economic, and security partnerships between India and Seychelles across multiple domains. India and Seychelles signed key MoUs including the implementation of UPI, Jan Aushadhi generic medicines export, and an Extradition Treaty. Agreements were also concluded for peaceful space exploration, healthcare infrastructure, recognition of seafarers, and an Exim Bank Line of Credit. India gifted defence assets like a Fast Patrol Vessel, utility vehicles, boats, ambulances, and essential supplies like rice and cement. New initiatives included launching a commemorative logo for 50 years of diplomatic relations and Seychelles joining the CDRI. Contingents from the Assam Regiment and the Indian Navy participated in the National Day parade during the visit.

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** Seychelles · **Who:** PM Narendra Modi, President Dr. Patrick Herminie · **Prelims:** NPCI International Payments Ltd. and the Central Bank of Seychelles signed an MoU for UPI implementation.; Seychelles joined the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI).; India gifted a Fast Patrol Vessel and PS Zoroaster underwent refit support.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands India's digital public infrastructure footprint globally through the export of UPI.; Strengthens India's strategic presence and security cooperation in the western Indian Ocean region.*

Static — India and Seychelles share robust maritime and diplomatic ties, with India playing a crucial security and development partner in the western Indian Ocean. The Unified Payments Interface (UPI) is India's mobile-based fast payment system, developed by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI). The Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana (PMBJP) aims to provide quality generic medicines at affordable prices through dedicated outlets.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Economy, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Social Justice & Welfare

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Gives States Last Chance On Menstrual Hygiene Compliance

The Supreme Court warned States and Union Territories that their Chief Secretaries could face contempt notices for failing to report on menstrual hygiene facilities. The trigger was the failure of States and UTs to respond to the Union Government's request for written reports on implementing court directions. The core issue is the persistent lack of basic sanitation and menstrual hygiene infrastructure in schools, which hampers girl students' education. A bench of Justice JB Pardiwala and Justice R Mahadevan gave States and UTs one final opportunity to submit the required information. The Supreme Court previously recognized menstrual hygiene as part of the fundamental right to life under Article 21 in its January 30, 2026 judgment. The court's directives mandate nationwide implementation of the Union Government's Menstrual Hygiene Policy for Classes 6 to 12 in all schools. Schools are directed to provide functional toilets with water, free sanitary napkins, management corners, proper maintenance, and safe waste disposal. The Union Government has been asked to prepare a questionnaire and coordinate with States to collect detailed reports on remaining gaps.

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Justice JB Pardiwala, Justice R Mahadevan, Aishwarya Bhati, Dr Jaya Thakur · **Prelims:** Menstrual hygiene is recognized as a fundamental right under Article 21 of the Indian Constitution.; The Supreme Court directives cover students in Classes 6 to 12 across government and private schools.; The next hearing of the case is scheduled for December 14, 2026.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces the judicial expansion of Article 21 to include sanitation, health, and dignity as fundamental entitlements.; Seeks to eliminate infrastructural barriers that cause high dropout rates among adolescent girls in rural and remote areas.*

Static — Article 21 of the Indian Constitution guarantees the right to life and personal liberty, which the judiciary has progressively interpreted to include health, dignity, and a clean environment. The Supreme Court of India functions as the apex judicial body and guardian of the Constitution under Article 124, possessing powers to issue contempt notices under Article 129. Menstrual hygiene management in Indian schools is supported by national guidelines aiming to improve attendance, reduce dropouts, and ensure adolescent health.

Syllabus: GS2: Social Justice & Welfare, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

indianmasterminds.com: read the source

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Yes Bank weighs next steps after SC upholds verdict on AT-1 bond write-down

Yes Bank announced it is examining the detailed Supreme Court judgment regarding the write-down of AT-1 bonds worth Rs 8,415 crore. The Supreme Court dismissed appeals filed by Yes Bank, the RBI, and the Union government, upholding the Bombay High Court verdict. The core issue involves the legality of writing off perpetual Additional Tier-1 bonds during the bank's reconstruction in March 2020. The Supreme Court stated that the administrator lacked the authority to write off the bonds without a specific provision in the reconstruction scheme. The bench criticized the RBI for acting as a mere bystander while Yes Bank's CET1 ratio dropped to an astonishingly low 0.6 per cent. The court noted that putting investors at risk for administrative lapses and failing to follow the Master Circular was unfair. The Bombay High Court had initially quashed the write-down decision on January 20, 2023, but kept it in abeyance for appeals. Yes Bank stated it has access to capital-management levers and flexibility to undertake additional capital actions for growth objectives.

When: October 16, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Yes Bank, Reserve Bank of India, Supreme Court of India, Bombay High Court · **Prelims:** Value of the AT-1 bonds written down: Rs 8,415 crore.; Date of the original write-down decision by Yes Bank: March 14, 2020.; Date of the Bombay High Court judgment upheld by the apex court: January 20, 2023.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces legal protections for retail and institutional investors against arbitrary administrative write-downs of high-risk bonds.; Highlights regulatory oversight responsibilities of the central bank during financial distress and bank reconstructions.*

Static — Additional Tier-1 (AT-1) bonds are unsecured, perpetual bonds issued by banks to bolster their capital base and meet Basel III capital norms. These instruments carry no maturity date and pay higher interest rates, but they can be permanently written down or converted to equity if a bank hits a distress trigger. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) regulates banking operations in India under the Banking Regulation Act, 1949, and sets capital adequacy guidelines.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

news18.com: read the source · also reported by Fortune India, ThePrint, The Economic Times

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI MPC raises FY27 inflation forecast to 5.2%, projects GDP growth at 7.1%

The revised forecasts were announced during the latest monetary policy review. The RBI Monetary Policy Committee has increased the FY27 inflation projection to 5.2% while estimating GDP growth at 7.1%.

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** India · **Who:** RBI Monetary Policy Committee · **Prelims:** FY27 inflation forecast is raised to 5.2%.; FY27 GDP growth is projected at 7.1%.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Important for UPSC aspirants tracking economic policy, central banking, inflation targeting, and growth trends.; Provides insights into how the central bank navigates price stability versus economic growth objectives.*

Static — The Monetary Policy Committee is a statutory and institutionalized framework under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934, for maintaining price stability while keeping in mind the objective of growth. The MPC consists of six members: the RBI Governor as chairperson, the Deputy Governor in charge of monetary policy, one officer of the Bank nominated by the Central Board, and three external members appointed by the central government. External members hold office for a period of four years and are not eligible for reappointment.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Business Standard: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

IDBI Bank sale to Fairfax enters final lap, RBI nod now key: DIPAM

The strategic sale of IDBI Bank will be completed by the end of FY27, subject to clearance from the Reserve Bank of India. The government approved selling a 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank to Canada's Fairfax Financial Holdings for about Rs 53,000 crore. Fairfax will acquire the government's 30.48% stake for Rs 26,620 crore and LIC's 30.24% stake for Rs 26,440 crore. Fairfax will pay Rs 81 per share, which is higher than the benchmark fair value of Rs 75.99 determined by two independent valuation agencies. Fairfax must submit technical papers and credentials to the RBI to meet compliance and regulatory requirements before signing a share purchase agreement. The strategic buyer must make an open offer to minority shareholders to protect their interests after the share purchase agreement is signed. LIC has been directed by the market regulator to reduce its remaining stake in IDBI Bank from 19% to 15% post-divestment to increase public float. The sale process, launched in 2022, faced hurdles earlier this year when initial offers came in below the government's reserve price.

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Arunish Chawla, Fairfax Financial Holdings, Reserve Bank of India, LIC · **Prelims:** Stake sold to Fairfax: 60.72%; Total transaction value: About Rs 53,000 crore ($5.5 billion); Acquisition price per share: Rs 81

> ***Why it matters —*** *It represents the largest foreign direct investment and strategic transaction in India's banking sector.; It advances the government's long-term banking privatisation and asset monetization agenda.*

Static — DIPAM functions under the Ministry of Finance, handling matters related to central government investment in equity and disinvestment of central public sector undertakings. The Reserve Bank of India regulates banking entities under the Banking Regulation Act, 1949, and evaluates the fit-and-proper status of promoters and strategic investors. Privatization of public sector banks involves reducing government equity below 50 percent, shifting management control to private entities.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

msn.com: read the source

Agriculture & Allied

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India’s Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses

The strategic focus on pulse self-sufficiency was highlighted in recent government releases regarding agricultural self-reliance. India is undertaking a mission to achieve self-reliance in pulse production to secure domestic food supplies.

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Government of India · **Prelims:** India is the world's largest producer and consumer of pulses.; The mission focuses on achieving Aatmanirbharta in pulses.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces vulnerability to global price volatility and import dependencies.; Improves rural incomes and agricultural sustainability.*

Static — Pulses are leguminous crops grown across India, serving as a primary source of protein for a large vegetarian population. India is the world's largest producer, consumer, and importer of pulses. Major pulses grown in India include chickpea (chana), pigeon pea (tur), lentil (masoor), mung bean, and urad bean.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

Press Information Bureau: read the source

Environment & Ecology

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

As disasters mount, next UN climate summit faces a test of trust

Representatives of three successive summit presidencies gathered at UN Headquarters to discuss restoring trust in global climate action ahead of COP31. The meeting was triggered by mounting climate disasters, a strengthening El Niño, and projections showing the world heating up by 2.8 degC above pre-industrial levels. The core issue debated was how to turn international commitments into tangible action and ensure climate finance is available, accessible, affordable, and predictable. COP31 will be hosted in Antalya, Türkiye, from 9 to 20 November, with negotiations led under an unprecedented joint arrangement with Australia. Türkiye outlined plans to accelerate clean energy, reduce methane emissions, and strengthen climate resilience during the upcoming summit. Türkiye and the UNDP developed the Climate Implementation Bridge initiative to transform national climate commitments into investment-ready projects connected with financing. Australia emphasized listening to vulnerable communities, partnering with those in need, and implementing practical initiatives grounded in science and local needs. The assembly president stressed that COP31 must demonstrate that multilateralism delivers rather than remaining just another negotiating milestone.

When: 9 to 20 November · **Where:** Antalya, Türkiye · **Who:** Khalilur Rahman, Ahmet Yldz, James Larsen, UNDP · **Prelims:** COP31 will be held in Antalya, Türkiye.; The dates for COP31 are 9 to 20 November.; The Climate Implementation Bridge was developed with the UN Development Programme (UNDP).

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the growing disconnect between global climate targets and current warming trajectories.; Brings attention to the critical need for accessible, affordable, and predictable climate finance for vulnerable nations.*

Static — The Conference of the Parties (COP) is the supreme decision-making body of the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), established in 1994. The Paris Agreement, adopted at COP21 in 2015, aims to hold the increase in global average temperature to well below 2 degC above pre-industrial levels and pursue efforts to limit it to 1.5 degC. The United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) works in about 170 countries and territories to eradicate poverty, reduce inequalities, and build resilience to sustain development results.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Environment & Ecology, International Relations, Disaster Management

UN News: read the source

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

ISRO Completes Crew Module-Service Module Separation Tests for Gaganyaan Mission

ISRO successfully completed a series of Crew Module and Service Module Separation Tests for the Gaganyaan missions. The Gaganyaan Orbital Module consists of a Crew Module and a Service Module connected by a separation system and umbilical connections. The modules function as a single integrated unit from launch until the completion of the on-orbit phase. Before re-entering Earth's atmosphere, the Crew Module separates from the Service Module through precisely sequenced pyrotechnic devices and jettisoning systems. A test setup was realized at Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre in Thiruvananthapuram to validate the design adequacy and simulate separation. The tests successfully validated the separation system and demonstrated the robustness and shock-survivability of critical subsystems inside the Crew Module. Tested subsystems included Avionics, Inertial Navigation Systems, Thermal Protection Systems, and pyrotechnic devices of the Uprighting and Environmental Control systems. The successful tests provide necessary confidence for the upcoming first uncrewed Gaganyaan Mission targeted for launch in 2026.

When: 2026 · **Where:** Thiruvananthapuram · **Who:** ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation) · **Prelims:** The tests were realized at Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre in Thiruvananthapuram.; The uncrewed Gaganyaan Mission (G1) is targeted for launch in 2026.; The Gaganyaan Orbital Module comprises a Crew Module and a Service Module.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Validates the critical separation mechanism required for astronaut safety during re-entry.; Ensures shock-survivability of vital subsystems like avionics and thermal protection systems.*

Static — The Indian Space Research Organisation is the national space agency of India, headquartered in Bengaluru and operating under the Department of Space. Established in 1969, ISRO formulates and executes space science, research, and launch vehicle programmes for national development. Gaganyaan is India's flagship human spaceflight programme aimed at demonstrating human spaceflight capability by launching a crew to an orbit of 400 km.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source · free copy on isro.gov.in · also reported by The Hindu

GS3 MAKE NOTES

TDB-DST signs agreement with QNu Labs for Rs. 150 crore RDI support to strengthen India's indigenous quantum-secure technology ecosystem

In a significant step towards strengthening India's capabilities in quantum technologies and secure communications, the Technology Development Board (TDB), Department of Science & Technology (DST), Government of India, has signed an agreement with QNu Labs Private Limited, Bengaluru, Karnataka for financial support of Rs. 150 crore under the Research Development and Innovation (RDI) Fund. The project, with a total cost of Rs. 300 crore, aims to develop an indigenous technology backbone for India's Quantum Secure and Sensing Networks (IQSN). The programme will advance a portfolio of technologies from Technology Readiness Levels (TRL) 4–5 towards TRL-9, supporting the development, integration and va

When: 2026-10-16 · **Where:** Bengaluru, Karnataka · **Who:** Technology Development Board, Department of Science & Technology, QNu Labs Private Limited · **Prelims:** TDB-DST signed an agreement with QNu Labs Private Limited based in Bengaluru, Karnataka.; The financial support provided under the RDI Fund is Rs. 150 crore.; The total project cost for the India's Quantum Secure and Sensing Networks is Rs. 300 crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens India's indigenous capabilities in quantum technologies and secure communications.; Helps build a sovereign quantum-security and sensing technology stack across critical pillars like identity, location, network, and time integrity.*

Static — The Technology Development Board is a statutory body established under the Technology Development Board Act of 1995 to promote indigenous technology and commercialize it. The Department of Science and Technology functions under the Ministry of Science and Technology, Government of India, and promotes new areas of science and technology. Quantum technology leverages the principles of quantum mechanics to develop computing, communication, and sensing applications with ultra-high security.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU, Data/Stats

PIB: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Bengaluru scientists decode solar eruptions using Aditya-L1 and Proba-3 satellites

Scientists from the Indian Institute of Astrophysics Bengaluru alongside international researchers jointly analysed observations of solar eruptions using India's Aditya-L1 and Europe's Proba-3 spacecraft. The study combined data from Aditya-L1's VELC and Proba-3's ASPIICS instruments to measure the mass density and energy of coronal mass ejections close to the Sun. Coronal mass ejections are enormous bursts of magnetised plasma expelled from the Sun that can trigger geomagnetic storms and disrupt satellite operations. Observing coronal mass ejections in the inner corona has traditionally been challenging leaving limited information about how their energy is divided between motion heat and magnetic fields. Aditya-L1's VELC instrument provides spectroscopic measurements of temperature and density while Proba-3's ASPIICS instrument captures images revealing shape movement and mass. The team identified two coronal mass ejections observed simultaneously by both instruments on September 14 and September 16 2025. The first coronal mass ejection travelled at around 645 kilometres per second while the second moved more slowly at approximately 145 kilometres per second.

When: 2025-09-14 · **Where:** Sun-Earth L1 point · **Who:** Indian Institute of Astrophysics · **Prelims:** Aditya-L1 was launched on September 2 2023 and entered its halo orbit at the L1 point on January 6 2024.; Proba-3 was launched by the European Space Agency on December 5 2024.; The study analysed two coronal mass ejections observed on September 14 and September 16 2025.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps scientists understand the earliest stages of solar eruptions and how energy is divided between motion heat and magnetic fields.; Improves space weather forecasting to better protect satellites communication systems and navigation networks from geomagnetic disturbances.*

Static — Aditya-L1 is India's first dedicated solar mission launched by the Indian Space Research Organisation on September 2 2023 into a halo orbit around the Sun-Earth L1 point. The Visible Emission Line Coronagraph is the primary payload on Aditya-L1 developed by the Indian Institute of Astrophysics in collaboration with the Indian Space Research Organisation. Proba-3 is the European Space Agency's precision formation-flying mission launched on December 5 2024 using two spacecraft flying 150 metres apart to create an artificial solar eclipse.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Infrastructure & Energy

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on indiatoday.in · also reported by ISRO

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

GSAT-7C Satellite

The Ministry of Defence signed a contract worth 2,563 crore rupees with NewSpace India Limited on October 15, 2026. The agreement is for the acquisition of the GSAT-7C satellite to strengthen the secure communication network of the Indian Air Force. The core issue is enhancing military communication security and ensuring reliable beyond-line-of-sight connectivity for aerial assets. GSAT-7C is a planned geosynchronous military communication satellite designed exclusively to serve the Indian Air Force. The satellite will support secure communication through software-defined radios whose functions can be modified using software. Unlike GSAT-7A which serves both the Army and Air Force, GSAT-7C is dedicated exclusively to the Indian Air Force. The satellite is indigenously designed, developed, and manufactured by NewSpace India Limited based in Bengaluru. The project supports the government's Make in India and Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiatives in the defence sector. The satellite is expected to become fully operational by the year 2030.

When: October 15, 2026 · **Where:** Bengaluru · **Who:** Ministry of Defence, NewSpace India Limited · **Prelims:** Contract value: 2,563 crore rupees; Date of contract: October 15, 2026; Developer: NewSpace India Limited Bengaluru

> ***Why it matters —*** *It enhances the operational capabilities and secure networking of the Indian Air Force.; It promotes indigenous defence manufacturing under Make in India and Aatmanirbhar Bharat.*

Static — NewSpace India Limited is a central public sector enterprise under the Department of Space and the commercial arm of ISRO, incorporated in 2019. ISRO was founded in 1969 under the Department of Space to manage national space programmes, research, and satellite development. Geosynchronous satellites orbit the Earth at an altitude matching the Earth's rotation period, appearing stationary over a fixed geographic location.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU, Data/Stats

ForumIAS: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports issues operational guidelines for revised Scheme of Assistance to National Sports Federations (NSFs)

The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports issued operational guidelines for the revised Scheme of Assistance to National Sports Federations (NSFs). The government approved the continuation of the scheme for the 2026-27 to 2030-31 period, coinciding with the 16th Finance Commission cycle. The scheme has a total financial outlay of Rs 7,386.74 crore to support Indian athletes for major international sporting events.

PIB: source

ECONOMY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

RBI approves amalgamation of Indian branches of Emirates NBD Bank P.J.S.C. with RBL Bank Limited

The Reserve Bank of India has approved the amalgamation of the Indian branches of Emirates NBD Bank P.J.S.C. with RBL Bank Limited. The merger is scheduled to take effect officially from December 1, 2026. Following the amalgamation, all Indian branches of Emirates NBD Bank will function as branches of RBL Bank. The development follows Emirates NBD acquiring a 60 percent majority stake in RBL Bank on June 18, 2026.

RBI: source

ECONOMY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Vijay launches Tamil Nadu Semiconductor Ecosystem Scheme 2026

Tamil Nadu officially launched the Semiconductor Ecosystem Scheme to position the state as a premier destination for advanced electronics manufacturing. The program was unveiled by Chief Minister Joseph Vijay on Thursday to cultivate a comprehensive value chain for semiconductor production. The scheme aims to cover design, research, fabrication, assembly, testing, packaging, and the supply of raw materials and specialized equipment.

The Hindu: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Cabinet Approves Bhavantar Scheme For Soybean Growers Across Madhya Pradesh

The Madhya Pradesh state cabinet approved the Bhavantar Bhugtan Yojana for the Kharif 2026 season under the Centre’s PM-AASHA initiative. The scheme aims to ensure soybean farmers receive prices aligned with the minimum support price. Farmers must register their names on the Food Department’s e-Uparjan portal by October 17 to receive benefits. The designated sale period for the scheme will run from October 22 to January 15.

freepressjournal.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Don't try to bulldoze Bill again, call all-party meet to discuss delimitation proposals: Kharge to Modi

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to call an all-party meeting to discuss new delimitation proposals. Kharge flagged an unprecedented 64-day delay in proroguing the Monsoon Session of Parliament since it was adjourned sine die on August 13. The opposition leader cautioned against bulldozing any far-reaching Constitutional Amendment Bill through Parliament without proper consultation.

The Hindu: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Secretary, Department of Urban Development, MoHUA chairs 10th meeting of CSMC under PMAY-U 2.0

Over 1.93 lakh additional houses were approved under Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana - Urban 2.0 (PMAY-U 2.0) during the 10 th meeting of the Central Sanctioning and Monitoring Committee (CSMC), held in New Delhi on 16 th October 2026 under the chairmanship of Shri Satendra Singh, Secretary, Department of Urban Development (DoUD), Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA).

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

14th India-Mongolia Joint Working Group meeting reaffirms commitment to strengthening bilateral defence partnership

India and Mongolia held their 14th Joint Working Group meeting in Ulaanbaatar on October 16, 2026. The meeting reviewed ongoing bilateral defence cooperation and discussed measures to expand collaboration in mutually identified areas. Both delegations exchanged views on regional and international developments and reiterated their commitment to sustained dialogue.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS APPOINTMENT QUICK READ

Shri Sudhakar Dalela appointed as the next Ambassador of India to Nepal

Shri Sudhakar Dalela has been appointed as the next Ambassador of India to Nepal. The appointment precedes Prime Minister Balen Shah's expected official bilateral visit to India in November. Dalela succeeds Naveen Srivastava, who held the post since June 2022. Dalela is a 1993-batch Indian Foreign Service officer who was serving as Secretary (Economic Relations) in the Ministry of External Affairs.

indiatoday.in: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

India, Britain to pass Japan 2027 GDP rankings, IMF says

The International Monetary Fund projected that India and Britain will surpass Japan's nominal gross domestic product in 2027. This shift is triggered by continuous weakness in the Japanese yen against the US dollar coupled with sluggish domestic economic growth. At stake is the shifting balance of global economic power as high-growth developing economies outpace mature, stagnating advanced nations.

msn.com: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Chandigarh gets its first Ramsar site. Sukhna Lake is a 68-year-old man-made reservoir

Sukhna Lake in Chandigarh and Sauj Jheel in Uttar Pradesh have been declared Ramsar wetland sites, taking India's total Ramsar sites to 103. The designation recognizes Sukhna Lake for supporting endangered waterbirds like the common pochard and Pallas' fish eagle. Union Environment Minister Bhupendra Yadav highlighted India's ongoing efforts to conserve wetlands and wetland ecosystems via a social media post.

theprint.in: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE QUICK READ

Kinnal Art, History, Features, Techniques, Materials and GI Tag

Kinnal art is a traditional wooden craft originating from Kinhal village in Koppal district, Karnataka. The craft traces its historical roots to the Vijayanagara period, gaining prominence during the 15th and 16th centuries. Traditional Chitragara artisans created wooden carvings and temple murals for royal courts and temples like Hampi. The craft features intricate designs, vibrant colours, and detailed ornamentation on toys, religious idols, and figurines.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Odisha Extends Antyodaya Gruha Yojana till 2029

The Odisha government announced the extension of the Antyodaya Gruha Yojana by two years until 2029 to construct an additional 2,91,666 houses. The decision aims to accelerate efforts to provide houses to all eligible poor and vulnerable households left out of the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana. The total project outlay of Rs 7,550 crore remains unchanged, but Rs 3,500 crore from the repair component is diverted to new house construction.

newindianexpress.com: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

RBI may announce unscheduled rate hike amid inflation, rupee pressures: Union Bank report

The Reserve Bank of India could raise interest rates before its scheduled December policy meeting due to rising inflation and rupee pressures. A Union Bank of India research report highlights that an inter-meeting rate hike or a 50 basis point hike in December is possible. India's wholesale inflation surged to 11.39 per cent in September from 9.92 per cent in August, exceeding market estimates.

msn.com: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES QUICK READ

New species of Wild Brinjal discovered in Andaman

Botanical explorations in the Andaman region led to the identification of this new plant species. A new species of wild brinjal has been discovered by researchers in the Andaman islands.

Andaman Sheekha: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | QUICK READ

Five Rare Plants Join the IUCN Red List as Global Assessments Reveal Rising Extinction Risk

Recent global assessments revealed rising extinction risks, prompting the inclusion of these five rare plants on the IUCN Red List. Five rare plant species have been added to the IUCN Red List after global assessments highlighted their increasing extinction risk.

Bioengineer.org: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT | QUICK READ

Delhi cabinet approves proposal to create its own SDRF for disaster response

The Delhi cabinet approved a proposal to set up a dedicated State Disaster Response Force to handle emergencies in the capital. The decision follows a building collapse in Satya Niketan last month that killed seven people, highlighting growing disaster vulnerabilities. Delhi currently relies on the NDRF, Delhi Fire Services, police, and other agencies for rescue and relief operations during emergencies.

hindustantimes.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

Maldives Advances Bid to Secure UNESCO World Heritage Status for Seven Historic Coral-Stone Mosques

The Maldives recently made progress in its ongoing diplomatic and technical efforts to submit the formal nomination to UNESCO. The Maldives is advancing its bid to secure UNESCO World Heritage status for seven historic coral-stone mosques.

ShiaWaves: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Myanmar and India sign MoUs on QIP implementation

The signing of MoUs for QIP implementation between India and Myanmar. India and Myanmar signed Memorandums of Understanding for the implementation of Quick Impact Projects.

Global New Light Of Myanmar: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | APPOINTMENT | QUICK READ

Govt reconstitute FSIB, appoints former MSME secretary SCL Das as chairman

The central government reconstituted the Financial Services Institutions Bureau (FSIB) and appointed former MSME Secretary S C L Das as its new chairman. The reconstitution was carried out through an official government notification establishing the chairperson and part-time members for a three-year tenure. FSIB acts as the central headhunter for recommending top-level executive appointments in public sector banks, financial institutions, and insurance firms.

theprint.in: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 GS3 Putting plurilaterals to good use: India signals change in WTO stance by engaging in plurilateral agreement discussions after BRICS declaration

India submitted a paper to the WTO signaling a willingness to engage in discussions on plurilateral 'coalition of the willing' agreements following the BRICS New Delhi Declaration. Previously, New Delhi maintained a rigid stance against plurilaterals, arguing they lacked an explicit mandate and relying on consensus-based decision-making. Reactions to the submission are mixed, with optimists viewing it as an opening for dialogue and pessimists seeing it as a tactical ploy to stall progress.

Economic Times

GS2 GS3 UPSC Editorial Analysis: India’s AI Boom

India aims to become a global leader in artificial intelligence through initiatives like the IndiaAI Mission and NITI Aayog's AI for All. Behind advanced algorithms lie millions of human data annotators and content moderators known as humans-in-the-loop who label data and remove harmful content. The core issue is how India can pursue rapid technological growth without exploiting the ordinary workers who form the foundation of AI.

Insights on India

GS3 A reality check on AI boom: Eight risks to look out for

Capital markets are beginning to price the distance between what artificial intelligence promises and what it earns. Nvidia backed Firmus withdrew a nearly $5 billion IPO after investor resistance, while OpenAI and Anthropic postponed their trillion dollar listings. The AI boom now faces eight major risks, divided equally into four financial risks and four beyond the balance sheet. AI companies are spending heavily on data centres and models in anticipation of future revenues, heavily outrunning actual earnings.

ForumIAS

GS2 Metrics to Minds — Restoring Purpose to Universities

India's higher education system increasingly relies on standardised entrance examinations and numerical indicators to assess students, teachers, and researchers. Entrance exams like NEET, JEE, and UGC NET aim for uniform selection but may overlook critical thinking, originality, and intellectual depth. Academic recruitment and promotions heavily use publication counts, research scores, and numerical weight for doctoral degrees, which can compromise quality. Multiple-choice tests often reward memorisation and test techniques rather than independent reasoning, creativity, and deep understanding.

The Hindu

GS2 Uniform, but for which gender(s)? India's UCC push faces a crucial question on same-sex couples and transgender rights

Amit Shah announced that the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) will be in force across all 21 NDA-governed states before the 2029 general election. The push for UCC raises the critical question of whether current state codes are truly uniform for all citizens. The authors argue that if equality is the core argument for UCC, it cannot abandon queer citizens in the drafted legislation.

Economic Times

GS3 GST 3.0 unclogs the system, eases input tax credit rules and relaxes arrest provisions for taxpayers

The editorial discusses the implementation and impact of the new GST 3.0 framework. GST 3.0 brings significant reforms by easing input tax credit rules and relaxing arrest provisions to simplify compliance.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Andy Mukherjee: Rupee defence—It shouldn't be left to unconventional measures while regular policy tools gather dust

The piece was reported in Mint on October 16, 2026, amid discussions on RBI's recent strategies to bolster the currency's value. The editorial discusses how the Reserve Bank of India should rely on straightforward policy tools rather than unconventional measures to defend the rupee. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has of late resorted to a battery of measures to bolster the currency's value, many of which could exact a high price down the line.

Mint

GS2 GS3 Best of Opinion: An opportunity to rethink the infrastructure of justice

The daily compilation of editorials and columns highlights ongoing debates surrounding India's economic reforms, industrial targets, and governance structures. The opinion pieces review current national issues including IDBI Bank privatisation, steel sector goals, tribunal reforms, and AI applications in infrastructure. Today's editorials and columns examine the IDBI Bank privatisation deal, India's steel ambitions, tribunal reforms, AI-driven infrastructure improvements and a book on the changing geopolitical order

Business Standard

GS2 Surjit Bhalla: On SIR, Opposition doth protest too much. ECI has been more right than wrong

On October 5, the Congress president demanded the resignation of the CEC, cancellation of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR), and a return to paper ballots. On October 10, more than 2,000 people were detained in Delhi as protestors escalated demands to include freezing the SIR, rolling back rolls to January 2025, and suspending elections. The author argues that the political opposition's protests lack logic, substance, and common sense, focusing on regime change rather than constructive reform.

msn.com

GS2 UPSC Editorial Analysis: Resolving the Spatial Mismatch in India's Higher Education

India faces a structural spatial contradiction where higher educational supply does not match the geography of youth demographic demand. States like Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, and Rajasthan have high youth cohorts with demographic dividends lasting into 2040-2050. Southern and western states like Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka, and Maharashtra have completed fertility transitions with TFR below replacement levels. Southern states record 35 to 50 colleges per lakh eligible population, whereas Bihar has 7 to 8 and Uttar Pradesh has around 19.

Insights on India

GS3 Mint Quick Edit | Elephant in the room: Will policymakers let inflation rip or keep price levels stable?

It is in the news due to concerns over growing sovereign debt and whether policymakers will maintain price stability or let inflation rise. The editorial discusses the temptation for governments facing heavy sovereign debt burdens to use inflation as a tool to ease fiscal obligations. In theory, this may be easier to do in the US than in the Eurozone. But institutional integrity could wobble anywhere.

Mint

GS2 Back in the SSR,but why did it go?

The resumption of the suspended Special Summary Revision process by the Election Commission put it back in the news. Following previous delays, the Election Commission has resumed the Special Summary Revision (SSR) of electoral rolls. This process is critical for empowering young and first-time voters to register and correct any omissions. The prior suspension of SSR raised concerns, emphasizing the importance of transparency and clear communication from the Election Commission regarding these issues to uphold trust in the electoral system.

Economic Times

GS3 Can wildlife thrive in India without active human intervention?

It is in the news as an opinion piece addressing contemporary wildlife conservation strategies in India. This editorial discusses whether Indian wildlife can survive and thrive without active management and human intervention in protected areas. India faces a question of whether wildlife can thrive with limited human intervention

The Hindu

GS3 Ripples from the future: On the Nobel Prize for Economics 2026

The announcement of the Nobel Prize for Economics 2026 put the focus on long-term economic planning and development models. An editorial discussing the implications of the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economics and its policy lessons for India. The Economics Nobel rewards work that holds lessons for India

The Hindu

GS1 From 50 Years Ago-Nobel Prize: A Political Award
The piece was featured in the Economic and Political Weekly (EPW) under its 'From 50 Years Ago' recurring historical segment. An archival editorial from 50 years ago examines the political motivations and biases behind the selection of Nobel Prize winners.
EPW

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Is the Caste Census being sabotaged again? The upcoming Census 2027 inclusion of caste enumeration using an open-ended structure. An analysis warning that Census 2027's adoption of an open-ended structure for caste enumeration may render the collected data unusable, similar to the 2011 SECC.
Frontline

Disinvestment in India: Trends and Challenges The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs recently approved the strategic disinvestment of IDBI Bank, with Fairfax Financial Holdings acquiring a 60.72% stake. Upon completion, the Government of India and LIC will retain a combined 34% stake in IDBI Bank.
ForumIAS

Why the GCC-EU summit was recently postponed The high-level diplomatic summit between the GCC and the EU was postponed. The summit between the Gulf Cooperation Council and the European Union was recently postponed, delaying talks on economic, energy, and climate issues.
The Hindu

What changes under India's proposed BS-VII vehicle emission rules India has proposed Bharat Stage VII emission standards for passenger vehicles starting April 1, 2029. The rules add limits on exhaust emissions, real-world driving tests, battery durability, and non-exhaust pollution. The core debate centers on tightening pollution limits to align with European Euro 7 regulations and tackle urban air quality.
The Hindu

IDBI Bank sale: What deal means for India's larger disinvestment plans The sale of IDBI Bank is considered a bellwether for privatisation of state-linked financial institutions. The explainer addresses the strategic sale of IDBI Bank and its wider implications for India's disinvestment programme.
Indian Express

Trump launches 'Super Intelligence Force': Who is on the team and what is its 120-day deadline? US President Donald Trump announced a new Super Intelligence Force to coordinate the government's artificial intelligence strategy. The initiative follows a meeting with leading AI executives and an executive order issued on September 29 adopting the term super intelligence.
Hindustan Times

Can wildlife thrive in India without active human intervention? A tigress was released into the Buxa Tiger Reserve in West Bengal to build a self-sustaining tiger population, following Project Cheetah in Madhya Pradesh in 2022. Conservation scientists are debating whether India's wildlife can thrive without active human intervention like captive breeding or species reintroduction.
civilsdaily.com

How rogue AI agents targeted Indian firms and accessed sensitive data The rising incidents of automated and AI-driven cyberattacks targeting corporate infrastructure in India brought this issue to light. An explanation of how rogue AI agents breached Indian firms to access sensitive corporate data, highlighting emerging cyber threats.
Indian Express

Graphs, Data, Perspectives | Why bond yields are rising in all major countries Recent global financial data shows diverging trends in sovereign bond yields between major economies and China. An explainer on why bond yields are rising across major global economies while China remains an exception.
Indian Express

From Ancient Rome to Trump: How public executions evolved as an instrument of state power The topic is examined in an explainer article published by The Indian Express. An explainer tracing the historical evolution of public executions as a tool of state power from Ancient Rome to modern political discourse.
Indian Express

How religious conversion affects eligibility for caste-based reservation The rules regarding religious conversion and caste reservations remain a subject of ongoing legal debate and judicial scrutiny. This explainer details the legal and constitutional rules determining how religious conversion alters an individual's eligibility for caste-based reservations in India.
Indian Express

How are Yemen's Houthis attacking Saudi Arabia so effectively? Houthi militants controlling northwestern Yemen recently launched air assaults targeting Riyadh international airport and the headquarters of Saudi Aramco. These attacks have exposed vulnerabilities in Saudi Arabia's air defences, threatening its status as a safe international investment hub.
Economic Times

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Kigali Amendment: India’s Cooling Transition and Climate Commitments (Environment & Ecology) ForumIAS
- India, Canada sign commercial deals as both aim to seal trade pact by 2026 (International Relations) Economic Times
- NHRC, India takes suo motu cognizance of the reported borewell water contamination due to seepage of chemical-laden factory effluents near Ambad Industrial Area in Nashik district, Maharashtra (Governance & Policy) PIB
- China's trade barriers remain a hurdle to closer bilateral ties: Sitharaman (International Relations) Economic Times
- India-US trade deal would be concluded at the earliest: Sitharaman (International Relations) Business Standard
- Climate history finds monsoon fluctuation footprints from sediment transport to farming adaptations (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- India-Russia joint military exercise INDRA 2026 underway in Russia (International Relations) News On AIR
- India's forex reserves drop by $8.58 billion to $726.03 billion in week ended October 9: RBI (Economy) Economic Times
- Pakistan to chair IMF, World Bank boards next year for first time since 1953 (International Relations) The Hindu
- PM Modi, Canadian foreign minister discuss concluding CEPA by year-end (International Relations) Business Standard
- PCI issues safety guidelines for journalists covering protests, demonstrations (Governance & Policy) The Hindu
- Karnataka HC upholds constitutional validity of law on ‘prohibited’ and ‘regulated’ areas around ancient monuments (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Quarterly release of Performance Monitoring Dashboard of Infrastructure Sector in India (Governance & Policy) PIB
- Wild tusker Chakkakompan uses cleared elephant passage to move to national park in Keralam’s Idukki (Environment & Ecology) The Hindu
- Exercise Tarang Shakti: A Mirror to India’s Multipronged Engagements (Defence) The Diplomat
- India to reach 100 billion dollar of bilateral trade with Russia by 2030: Ambassador Vinay Kumar (International Relations) Economic Times
- Explore the significance of anticipatory action in disaster management. Identify the institutional and operational barriers to its adoption in India. Suggest measures for integrating forecast-based interventions into disaster preparedness. (Disaster Management) Insights on India
- India and Samoa sign MoU on project to support children, persons with disabilities (International Relations) IANS LIVE
- India’s centipede family tree extended with discovery of three new species from South India (Environment & Ecology) Research Matters
- India’s per capita GDP estimated below Bangladesh in 2026: IMF (Economy) Scroll.in
- Rules On Airfare Pricing Finalised, To Be Published Within Two Weeks: Centre Tells Supreme Court (Governance & Policy) LawBeat
- TERI and MeECL sign MoU to strengthen Meghalaya’s renewable energy sector (Infrastructure & Energy) Powerline Magazine
- India, St Kitts and Nevis sign MoU to share digital solutions implemented at population scale (International Relations) ET Government
- Distraction loading? Besieged by protests, Centre revives Delimitation Bill buzz (Polity & Constitution) The Federal
- India, Vietnam hold 4th Security Dialogue, review counter-terrorism, cybersecurity cooperation (International Relations) Malaysia Sun
- Uttarakhand CM Dhami approves accommodation of two Agniveers in 40th PAC Battalion as first batch set to complete service in November (Defence) ANI News
- India received 15% below normal monsoon rainfall this year: IMD (Geography) BusinessLine
- AIIA Marks a Decade of Service with Over 37.74 Lakh Patients Treated Across Its Healthcare Network (Health) PIB
- NCL Signs MoU for Rs. 30.75 Crore Expansion of Mining Engineering College in Singrauli (Education) Indian Masterminds
- India diversified crude oil sources from 27 to 41 amid disruptions in Hormuz, Red Sea: Hardeep Puri (Economy) Times of India
- PM Modi to visit to Canada on December 11 and 12 (International Relations) Times of India
- Ladakh still waits for the Article 371(K) draft (Polity & Constitution) Frontline
- India's September goods exports rise 23% as imports hit six-month low, narrowing trade deficit (Economy) Economic Times
- 800 million jobs at risk over 15 years? World Bank's Ajay Banga calls for global financing overhaul (Economy) Mint
- Breaking down the share of social groups among religions (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- UCC: The way forward (Polity & Constitution) Frontline
- Karnataka government to move Supreme Court over High Court ruling on quota cap (Polity & Constitution) Deccan Herald
- Putting plurilaterals to good use: India signals change in WTO stance by engaging in plurilateral agreemen (International Relations) The Economic Times
- There's Stark Non-Compliance With Direction For Cadre Review Of CAPFs, Says Supreme Court (Internal Security) LiveLaw
- INS Samarthak commissioned at Karwar, Vice President C.P. Radhakrishan terms it a milestone in self-reliant defence manufacturing (Defence) The Hindu
- Modi to visit Ottawa, Toronto, will see if it can be broadened out: Mark Carney (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- Governing the AI–Bio Convergence: India’s Evolving Biosecurity Challenge (Internal Security) Observer Research Foundation
- Can’t browbeat us, says Supreme Court, seeks replies from CEC, ECs on opposition plea (Polity & Constitution) Times of India

- State govt cannot receive gift of temple property from temporary trustee: SC (Polity & Constitution) The New Indian Express
- Reform global institutions to match new realities: EAM (International Relations) The Tribune
- Violent Naxalism isover, task now is toheal wounds: Amit Shah (Internal Security) Times of India
- National Security Dialogue | Diffusion and Disruption: Emerging Technologies, Non-State Actors and the Changing Distribution of Advanced Capabilities (Internal Security) Observer Research Foundation

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 21 must-know, 19 Prelims facts, 47 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (9), Economy (7), International Relations (6), Governance & Policy (5), Environment & Ecology (4), Science & Technology (3), Agriculture & Allied (2), Defence (1), Social Justice & Welfare (1), History, Art & Culture (1), Disaster Management (1). **Nothing today in —** Health, Education, Infrastructure & Energy, Internal Security, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): nothing today · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 1 · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 2 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 1

Full text — 42 of 67 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 9, PIB 5, Indian Express 5, msn.com 4, Economic Times 4, Insights on India 3, Vajiram & Ravi 3, ForumIAS 3, newindianexpress.com 2, Business Standard 2, freepressjournal.in 2, Hindustan Times 2, theprint.in 2, Mint 2

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